clear instructions from their respective headquarters. Neither of them had any information on any likely attempt on Indira Gandhi's life during her visit to New York, but were expecting demonstrations in front of the UN building on 28 September.

I also met some of my Sikh friends that day and the next day too. I talked to some friends from the west coast of the US, and from the Vancouver and Toronto areas on the phone in the evenings, and later too throughout my stay in Canada and the US. This time I did not go to Vancouver. Nor did I visit the US west coast, as I felt visiting Toronto and meeting Kuldip Singh Sodhi, the so-called consul general of Khalistan, would be more fruitful in completing the two assigned tasks. I contacted Sodhi by phone and some other friends from the Toronto area too, fixing meetings with them on 24 September. However, before leaving Ottawa I requested our man there to shift to Vancouver during the period of the PM's stay at New York and keep me and the Department posted about information of interest that came to his notice.

On the morning of 24 September I left Ottawa for Toronto. On my arrival I called Sodhi again to fix a meeting at a local restaurant. I was surprised to find that he was a bit hesitant and excused himself from meeting me on the pretext of being unwell. It appeared to me that he had not got clearance from his bosses in London for the meeting, presumably due to his meeting with me outside Richmond Hill Gurudwara in New York the previous year, during Indira Gandhi's visit (Chapter 5). Maybe he was in touch with my successor, the current station head at Ottawa, who did not give Sodhi *his* clearance to meet me, which is normal in such cases.

The good thing was that Sodhi was still willing to talk. To my direct and brief questions, he mentioned that as far as he knew there was no threat to Indira Gandhi's life during her visit to New York. He also told me that two or three busloads of Sikhs would leave Toronto for New York early on the morning of 28 September, to demonstrate in front of the UN building. He was not sure whether he would be accompanying them. When I requested him to somehow convince the demonstrators not to use foul language or derogatory slogans against Indira Gandhi, he said he had no control over their behaviour. He did agree to give it a try, though.